Till I Collapse

Written by

Francis Louie Ramoso

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DEDICATION

This book is for the ones who bled in silence.
For the ones who got called crazy for feeling what was real.
For the ones who broke down behind closed doors but still stood up the next day.

To my kids —
Annica, Eira, Euno —
One day you'll read this, and maybe cry.
But I pray you feel the strength in every scar I turned into a sentence.
I didn't have it all.
But I gave everything I had to keep my soul mine — and never let the world own yours.

To the ones who betrayed me —
Thank you.
You became my chapters.
You taught me how to write with truth, not with peace.

To the system that tried to chain me —
This is me breaking free.
This is me standing ***Till I Collapse.***

EPIGRAPH

They prayed I'd kneel.
I prayed I'd rise.
We both got what we asked for.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Title
Copyright
Dedication
Epigraph
Author's Note
Chapter 1: Silence Screaming
Chapter 2: Ghosts in the Mirror
Chapter 3: Leira
Chapter 4: Erica
Chapter 5: Annica
Chapter 6: Eira Euno
Chapter 7: Bloodline
Chapter 8: The War Inside the House
Chapter 9: The System's Rope
Chapter 10: The Chains I Can't See
Chapter 11: Screaming Through the Pen
Chapter 12: The Villain in Their Story
Chapter 13: Till I Collapse
Chapter 14: The Day I Said NO
Chapter 15: LOUIEWOOD
Chapter 16: If You're Reading This
Letter to the Reader
Acknowledgement
About the Author
Louiewood Legacy / About the Publisher
Unwritten Chapter (Louiewood Vault)

AUTHOR'S NOTE

I didn't write this book to be liked.
I wrote it because I was breaking.
Because the world around me — love, family, money, religion, systems —
was choking the life outta me, and the only thing I had left was this pen.

This is not fiction.
This is not cleaned up for your comfort.
It's pain. Regret. Rage.
It's a man trying to figure out if he's the villain, the victim, or just the last one standing.

You'll read things in here that might make you uncomfortable.
Good.
You'll read things I'm not proud of.
That's growth.

To the people I hurt — I see my flaws now.
To the people who hurt me — I survived you.

And to my kids — if you're holding this one day, know this:
I didn't write this from a castle.
I wrote it in a room I could barely breathe in, with nothing but faith that maybe,
just maybe, telling the truth would set us free.

This book isn't the end.
It's the fight before the freedom.
It's me — ***till I collapse.***

— Louie

CHAPTER 1: SILENCE SCREAMING

There's a kind of silence that don't feel peaceful. It's not calm, not healing. It's violent. It's heavy. It presses down on your chest like someone invisible sitting there, daring you to breathe. That's the silence I been living in. Not the absence of noise, but the presence of too much that nobody wants to say.

The room I'm in is small. Four walls, one bed, broken blinds, and a speaker in the corner playing *Till I Collapse* on loop like it's the only thing keeping my heart from stopping. I don't know what day it is. Time doesn't move right in this kind of silence. All I know is the weight in my chest and the burn in my head.

I been screaming inside. Screaming so loud I swear my soul's throat is raw. But out loud? Nothing. Just deep breaths, clenched teeth, and fists that tremble not from weakness, but from everything I gotta hold back.

People say, "Get a job." Like that's the problem. Like a paycheck can fix betrayal, fix being disrespected by the people you built with, fix being a man trying to stay standing with chains on his legs and a knife in his back.

I got a bike in debt. Laundry in debt. Rent creeping up like a thief. But that ain't the worst part. The worst part is I got people who said they loved me — who said they were with me — now playing chess while I'm drowning.

Erica. That name already tastes like bitterness. She smirked when I was hurting. Smiled while I bled truth. I looked her in the eyes and spit bars — not raps, but pain, anger, questions — and she smirked. That smile told me more than words ever could. It said, *"I see you breaking, and I don't care."*

And that's when I knew. I wasn't just hurt. I was hunted. Hunted for my spirit. My sanity. My **reality**.

I'd rather someone rob my wallet, G. Straight up. Take my phone. Jack my bike. Whatever. But don't rob my **reality**. Don't make me question what I know I feel. Don't gaslight me into thinking I'm the villain for reacting to disrespect.

I told her she changed. She told me I was insecure. I told her it felt off. She told me I was tripping. I got angry. She told the world I was toxic.

But what they didn't see was the way she moved. The way she slipped out mentally before she ever packed a bag. The way she stayed long enough to make me dependent — then backed off just enough to leave me starving.

And the worst part? Annica. Our daughter. Two years old. Bright eyes. Whole future ahead of her. And I can't even be the father I wanna be 'cause the world don't let broke men have feelings, or kids, or space to heal. They say, "man up," but when you do, they call you cold. When you break, they say you weak. When you speak, they say you angry.

I'm not angry. I'm exhausted. I'm not broken. I'm bleeding. I'm not toxic. I'm traumatized.

And still, I write.

Because that's all I got. Words. Pages. Truth. And a voice that refuses to stay silent, even when it shakes.

I don't know how this story ends. I don't even know what tomorrow looks like. But I know this page right here? It's real. It's mine. And it's louder than the silence they tried to bury me in.

So if you reading this, know — this ain't a comeback story yet. It's a survival letter. A scream with structure. A warning and a weapon.

And I'm still here. Still standing. Still writing...

...till I collapse.

CHAPTER 2: GHOSTS IN THE MIRROR

Some nights, I don't see myself in the mirror. I see the questions. The guilt. The doubt. The man who's not sure if he's breaking down or waking up.

I look into my own eyes and ask, "Was it really them? Or was it me?" And that's the most dangerous loop — the one where you blame yourself for everything just because nobody else will own their part.

You ever been gaslit so deep you start doubting your own senses? Like — you feel the shift in someone's energy, the distance, the strange looks, the delayed replies, the forced smiles... and when you bring it up?

"Why you so paranoid?"
"Stop overthinking."
"You're insecure."

And they say it smooth. They say it soft. They say it like they care. So you question yourself instead.

That's what I mean by ghosts in the mirror. They're not dead people — they're the versions of you that people killed without laying a hand on you.

They made me second-guess my gut. They trained me to apologize for reacting. They flipped the script so clean, I thought my hurt was the problem.

But here's the thing, G: *Your gut don't lie.* Your soul knows when something's wrong. When someone's moving grimy but smiling pretty. When love starts to feel like leverage. When your peace feels like a threat to their control.

Erica played it subtle. Leira played it soft. But both left fingerprints on my mind. And now, when I look in the mirror, I don't just see me — I see every version of me that tried to survive them.

I see the me that believed too long. The me that stayed too silent. The me that fought too loud. The me that begged. The me that left.

And the me that came back.

There's a kind of love that feels like drowning, and the crazy part is — you don't realize how deep under you are till you finally come up for air.

I thought love meant sacrifice. I thought being a man meant taking hits and never folding. I thought holding it all in made me stronger.

But silence ain't strength. It's a slow death. And guilt isn't always truth. Sometimes it's just a weight handed to you by people who don't wanna carry their own.

I'm learning that now. Not in books. Not in therapy. In real-time. In late nights. In quiet rooms. In loud music. In my daughter's eyes when I don't got the answers.

I write this not to blame — but to name. To name what happened. To name what I felt. To name what they won't admit.

Because if I don't, these ghosts will keep whispering lies every time I try to find myself again.

This chapter ain't a resolution. It's recognition. Of the patterns. The poison. The prison built from soft words and silent wars.

So next time I look in the mirror — I'll look past the ghosts. And finally see the man still standing. Still scarred. Still searching.

But alive.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 3: LEIRA

Some betrayals don't come with blood. They come with **smiles**. With **screenshots**. With **lies dressed in justice**. And Leira? She didn't just break my heart — she tried to **erase me.**

This chapter ain't easy to write. Because every word is a cut that never fully healed. But I swore to myself, if I'm telling my truth, I'm telling **all of it.**

Leira was the one I built with before Erica. We had two kids together — Eira and Euno. My blood. My little ones. The reason I kept standing through storms. I gave her love, even when I was bleeding. I gave her presence, even when I was broke. But she gave me betrayal, disguised as protection.

Let me break it down, G. She **cheated**. Not once. Not maybe. She did it. I felt it in my gut before I ever saw the signs. And when I confronted her — yeah, I got mad. Yeah, I called her names. Yeah, I broke down. I'm not perfect. But I never laid a hand on her. What I did was react to being played, disrespected, abandoned while still standing beside her.

But she flipped it. Like a script already written. She took every angry message, every outburst from a man who was breaking — and she **screenshot it.** Filed it. Built a **case**. Not for truth, but for **revenge.**

"Psychological abuse," they said.
But what about the abuse of silence?
The abuse of gaslighting?
The abuse of walking into court with crocodile tears and a hard drive of moments ripped out of context?

They locked me up. Real bars. Real time. Not for what I did — but for how she made it look.

Prison changes a man. But not the way people think. It ain't the walls. It ain't the food. It's the **realization** that someone you once held at night could stab you with the very love you gave.

Leira didn't just cheat. She didn't just lie. She turned the system into a weapon. And the world clapped for her while I sat in silence behind bars, wondering if my kids would remember my name.

I know I made mistakes. I know my anger burned loud. But what she did? Wasn't survival. It was **execution.**

I came out different. Not colder — but clearer. I learned that not every "victim" is innocent. That some people wear the mask of pain just to cover the blood on their hands.

This ain't to bash her. It's to **document** the truth. Because my kids might read this someday. And I need them to know — your father was flawed, but he was **never evil.** He loved too hard, reacted too raw, but he never stopped showing up.

Leira may have broken me. But she didn't finish me.

And when I write this, I don't write it as revenge. I write it so the ghosts don't win. So my story ain't just court papers and whispers. So the man inside the mirror finally sees his own reflection again.

This is for Eira. This is for Euno. This is for every father who's been framed by the very person they loved.

Still breathing. Still believing. Still writing...

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 4: ERICA

If Leira broke me in court, Erica broke me in silence.

This one different, G. It's not as loud. Not as obvious. But it's just as sharp.

Erica was my long-time partner. We built life in the same four walls. Shared food. Shared sleep. Shared pain. And we had Annica — my daughter. My light. My little fire in the middle of all this darkness. I wanted to hold it together. For her. For us.

But sometimes the people you love don't fight with you — they play chess **against** you. Quiet moves. Strategic. Smiling while setting you up for the fall.

She never had to cheat to break me. All she had to do was watch me fall apart and **smirk.** And she did.

I'd spit bars when I was angry, tryna vent the pain — and she'd look at me like my fire was entertainment. Like she was proud of breaking me down just to watch how I react. Like watching a man burn was part of her game.

I saw the face. That little smirk when I broke down. That's when I knew — I wasn't her partner anymore. I was her pawn.

Erica never raised her voice. Never packed punches. But she packed silence. Packed guilt. Packed manipulation. And she did it so clean, I started blaming myself for everything again.

She'd say, "You're too emotional."
She'd pull back love, then act like I was crazy for noticing. She'd disrespect me in small ways — but the moment I reacted? *"There you go again."*

And the cycle repeated. Me hurting. Her watching. Me apologizing. Her collecting receipts.

I knew she'd leave eventually. But not like that. Not after everything we've been through. And when she did, she left **Annica** in the middle.

That's what hurt the most, G. Not the disrespect. Not the games. But seeing my daughter caught in the crossfire of a love that turned toxic.

Now she gone. And I'm still chained to the debts — the bike debt, the washing debt, the emotional debt. Still tryna stand. Still tryna work. Still tryna write this book while the world presses me from all sides.

But I see it clear now. Erica ain't just a heartbreak. She's a mirror of the systems that wanna **own** me. Make me work. Make me kneel. Make me silent.

This chapter ain't just about her. It's about waking up to the realization that not every quiet woman is innocent. That control don't always shout — sometimes it whispers. Sometimes it smirks.

And when she comes back to get her things?
She won't just find a room. She'll find a man who finally saw the truth.

Still scarred. Still broke. Still bleeding. But writing.

Still writing...

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 5: ANNICA

When the world turned cold, she stayed warm. She small. Two years old. But somehow, she carried me when I couldn't even carry myself.

Annica — my daughter. Born in the middle of a storm. Grew inside a house already cracking. But her smile? It made me feel like there was still a reason to breathe.

There were nights I didn't know what I was doing, G. No money. No answers. Just me staring at a room that felt more like a trap than a home. But she'd laugh. Dance. Hug me without asking for anything. And that? That reminded me I still had a soul.

They got her now. Erica took her. And it's like they ain't just stole my blood — they stole my peace.

I ain't perfect. I never claimed to be. I messed up. I snapped. I said things out of pain. But I loved that little girl with everything in me. She didn't ask to be born into chaos. Didn't ask for systems. Didn't ask for court papers. Didn't ask for silence.

But here she is — a light trapped between two people who forgot how to love without war.

Annica, if you ever read this...

Know your father never gave up on you. Even when the world said he was unfit. Even when the system said he was broken. Even when your mother tried to erase me.

I never left. They just made it hard for me to stay.

Every bar I spit was a prayer. Every page I write is a map — leading back to you.

You saved me more times than you'll ever understand. You gave me reason to stay alive when everything else said "quit." You were my heartbeat when mine was fading.

This chapter? It ain't about pain. It's about purpose.

You, Annica, are my reason. Even when I fall short. Even when I lose battles. Even when I write this with tears on the keyboard and empty pockets.

I'm still standing. Still believing. Still writing...

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 6: EIRA & EUNO

Not all wars happen in the streets, G — some happen in the home. And some wars? You fight without bullets, without fists. You fight them with absence, guilt, distance... and love that ain't allowed to be felt.

This chapter is for the children caught in silence.

Eira. Euno.

Two names the system don't care about, but two souls I'd bleed for.

Eira is two, just like Annica. Euno still five months. Their mother, Leira, made sure we never built peace. And after she filed that case — turned our arguments into courtroom chains — everything got harder. Heavier. Colder.

We never got to sleep under one roof as a family. Not even once. We weren't allowed peace.

But I showed up when it mattered. I was there for Eira's birthday. I was there when they baptized her and Euno.

Catholic rituals. Water poured. Priest blessing names I didn't choose. And in that holy silence — I leaned in. I whispered what the priest would never say:

"You are not owned. You are free. Even if they baptize your name, your soul stays yours." — Papa

No cameras caught it. No crowd heard it. But the words were planted like seeds.

I don't know what kind of world they'll grow up in. Don't know what Leira will say about me. Don't know how many nights they'll wonder where I went.

But I hope one day they'll read this. All of it. And I hope they'll feel the truth in these pages:

You were always in my heart. Even when I wasn't allowed near.

I carry Eira's laugh like armor. I carry Euno's name like a sword.

I may not hold them every day — but I hold them in every verse. I write for them. I bleed for them.

And I refuse to let this world baptize them into ownership. Not the church. Not the system. Not even their mother's pain.

Their soul stays theirs. Their truth stays whole.

And I'll keep fighting for them...

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 7: BLOODLINE

My parents. My brothers. My sisters. My whole bloodline.

Sometimes they turn against me. Sometimes they misunderstand me.

But I love them in silence.

Every time they doubted me, I didn't fold — I used it as gasoline. I burned with it. Not to destroy. But to move. Because no argument could ever unchain this curse I carry. Only truth can.

I feel it in the way they talk. The way they avoid my eyes. The way their silence screams louder than their words.

They lost belief in me.

And honestly? I understand.

I'm in my room most of the time. I look broke. I sound lost. I carry too many ghosts to explain. But explaining don't change nothing — they want results, not reasons. So I stay quiet. Keep this pain locked in. Keep this fire hidden.

Because I know they're struggling too, G. I see it. My nephews grinding for meals. My parents praying for peace. My brothers looking for meaning. My sisters holding on to hope.

We all at war — just different battlefields.

So I don't blame them. I just carry mine without shouting.

Because love doesn't always need noise. Sometimes it's sacrifice. Sometimes it's bleeding in silence so they don't have to.

I grind while bleeding.

One day they'll understand. One day they'll see the books, the truth, the fight. One day they'll know I didn't give up — I just stayed low until it was time.

Until then? I write. I heal. I fight.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 8: THE WAR INSIDE THE HOUSE

It didn't start like war. It started like love.

But somewhere between the dirty dishes, the late-night arguments, and the broken silences, it turned. The house — the one that was supposed to be a shelter — became the battlefield.

I don't know the exact moment it shifted. Maybe it was when Erica stopped looking me in the eyes. Maybe it was when I started raising my voice, not to be cruel, but to be heard. Or maybe it was when Annica cried in the middle of the night, and instead of coming together, we blamed each other for the noise.

We weren't just living together — we were surviving each other.

Every word became a move. Every silence, a strategy. We were playing chess with our hearts. And G, I was losing.

Erica — she played her role. Cool, collected, but cutting deep. There were days she smiled when I was mad, like she fed on the chaos. And maybe she did, maybe that's how she stayed in control — by making me feel out of it. By turning my emotions into weakness.

But this ain't about blame. It's about what it felt like.

The moment I walked through that door, my chest tightened. Like the walls were closing in. Like I couldn't breathe right. Like I had to tiptoe around the very space that was supposed to hold my peace. And still, I stayed. For Annica. For the dream. For the hope that maybe it would shift back.

But love twisted into leverage. Affection became ammunition. And the arguments weren't about solutions — they were about survival.

She disrespected me in small, sharp ways. The kind that don't leave bruises but leave dents in the soul. She knew what strings to pull. What silence to weaponize. What words to drop and walk away from.

And G — I reacted. Yeah, I snapped sometimes. Called her out. Let my anger speak before my reason could. And I hated that. I hated who I became in that house.

Because when you're constantly being tested, constantly being doubted, you either break… or you explode.

There were nights I sat in the corner of the room, headphones on, "Till I Collapse" on loop. I didn't cry — I just clenched my fists and let the music hold me up. Because if I broke, who would hold Annica? Who would write this truth? Who would build Louiewood?

The war wasn't just between me and Erica. It was me versus myself. The pressure to stay calm when I was burning inside. The guilt for not being enough. The shame of not having a job to pay off the bike.

Sometimes I thought about letting it all go. Let the bike get impounded. Let Erica walk. Let the whole house burn metaphorically and just lock myself in the room and write.

But then Annica would laugh. And it would cut through the smoke.

She didn't choose this war. She didn't ask for this battlefield. But she was here. And I had to make sure she survived it.

So I stayed. Fought quiet battles. Swallowed my pride.

Until the day I couldn't anymore.

Because love that feels like war… Ain't love. It's captivity with kisses. It's prison with pillowcases. It's chains disguised as comfort.

And I realized — no matter how much I cared, I couldn't raise Annica inside a battlefield. I couldn't keep bleeding in a house that looked like home but felt like war.

That was the beginning of the end. The start of something honest.

The first step… To getting out alive.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 9: THE SYSTEM'S ROPE

Religion. Control. Money. Debt. Not in chains — but still shackled. Not in prison — but still owned.

I started seeing it when I looked around and saw that everything I thought was holy had hands in my pocket.

Pay this. Believe that. Kneel here. Obey there. And all the while, they smiling at you, calling it love. But love don't feel like this. Love don't make you feel like you're drowning while praying.

It started with debt. Not big at first — just enough to make you chase. To make you stress. Then it grows. Bike debt. Phone bills. Unpaid fees. Little by little, your life becomes a series of payments. And if you miss one? You lose something.

They say you're free, but try missing a payment. Try not bowing to the rules. Try questioning the script.

They'll say you're crazy. They'll say you're lazy. They'll say you're lost.

But maybe I ain't lost. Maybe I just see it now.

Even religion — they baptized my kids with water and words I never agreed to. They claimed souls I helped bring into this world without asking me if that's what I wanted for them.

I whispered to my babies that day: "You are not owned. You are free. Even if they baptize your name, your soul stays yours."

Because I know what ownership feels like. I've lived it. When your name ain't even yours no more — it belongs to a debt collector, a court case, a reputation built by lies.

G, they don't need whips anymore. They got expectations. They got systems. They got religion with rules and no room for

questions. They got you believing if you fall, it's your fault for not praying harder.

But I see it now. And seeing is the first step to breaking it.

I ain't angry at God. I'm angry at the ones who put on His name like a mask to make me bow.

And I ain't bowing no more.

This chapter ain't about faith — it's about freedom.

Because you can't serve your purpose while you're serving masters hiding behind altars.

So I'm cutting the rope. Not from God — but from the system that pretended to be Him.

And when I walk out of that grip, I walk free. Even if I'm broke. Even if I'm bleeding.

I walk free.

CHAPTER 10: THE CHAINS I CAN'T SEE

They don't look like chains. They look like bills. Receipts. Unpaid balances. Missed calls from collectors. Late fees stacking like bricks on my back.

They look like a bike I can't finish paying off. A washing machine debt I can't clean off my name. A room that feels more like a cell when I got no job, no exit.

They look like the hollow space in the fridge. The last scoop of rice. The sound of Annica crying for milk. The silence after I say, "Papa's working on it."

They look like smiles from people who think I'm lazy. Like nods from strangers who don't know I'm drowning. Like eyes judging me because they don't know what it feels like to break silently.

The chains don't clang like metal. They whisper like shame. They speak to me in the morning: "You're behind." They whisper at night: "You're failing."

They settle on your shoulders so long, you forget they're there. You think it's just life. You think it's normal. But deep down you know — you're carrying shit no man should carry alone.

You wake up heavy. You breathe heavy. You smile like nothing's wrong. Because nobody really wants the truth — they want you to play your part. Smile. Nod. Say "I'm okay."

But it's not okay.

Debt is a slow noose. It doesn't choke you quick. It just gets tighter every month. It's in the way your dreams feel further and further away. In the way your chest tightens when the bills come. In the way you wonder if you'll ever catch up — or if you're meant to lose.

It pulls you from your dreams and makes you pick survival instead. Dreams don't pay bills. Truth don't pay rent. So you trade soul for silence. You trade passion for paychecks you never see whole.

You start calculating how much truth you can afford to speak. How much time you can give your passion. How many lies you gotta tell just to keep the lights on. You start bargaining with your own soul, G. You start saying, "Just one more month like this. Then I'll go all in." But that month never ends.

And the world doesn't see it. They just see a man "not doing enough." But they don't know that doing nothing still takes everything you got. They don't see the battles inside your head. They don't see the weight on your back when you lie awake at 3AM wondering how to stretch nothing into something.

Sometimes I feel like I'm sprinting with no finish line. Running a marathon through mud, wearing chains, holding kids on my shoulders. Sometimes I feel like the system is laughing. Like it knows exactly how to keep me running in place.

You work just enough to stay broke. You earn just enough to owe more. You fight just enough to stay tired.

And through it all — I still got kids. Eira. Euno. Annica.

They didn't ask for this. They didn't choose this. But they looking at me like I'm Superman. Even when I feel like I'm bleeding in a phone booth. Even when I got no cape, no powers — just heart.

So I keep going. Not because I'm strong. But because quitting would mean I agree with the system. And I never will.

I got nothing but my words. My pages. My truth. And my will to fight back without fists.

I know the system ain't built for men like me to win. But I refuse to fold. I refuse to kneel.

And if that's all I got? Then I'll write till these chains fall off.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 11: SCREAMING THROUGH THE PEN

It wasn't fists I threw. It wasn't windows I shattered. It wasn't even their faces I screamed at.

It was the page.

This pen became my last breath. This book became my last shot. When the world had me cornered — broke, betrayed, branded a villain — I didn't pick up a weapon. I picked up truth.

Because I realized: If I can't fight them physically, I'll fight them with my story.

They control the courts. They twist the laws. They call you insane and make people believe it. They don't hear your side — they hear her screenshots. They don't see what led you to scream — only that you screamed. So the only weapon left? This. These words. This paper. This fire.

There's a different kind of scream — the one that don't echo in rooms, but in readers. That's the one I chose.

Every night, locked in this room, I bled on this page like it's the only way out. Not because I wanted revenge. But because I wanted *record.*

Let history know I existed. Let my kids know I fought. Let any man who feels like he's one punch away from collapse — know he ain't alone.

This ain't about clout. It's about proof.

I didn't die silent. I didn't go numb. I screamed through ink. I spit truth with every line. I wrote even when my hands shook. I wrote even when I hated myself. I wrote even when the world said I was done.

They wanted me to kneel. But I learned: words make you rise.

This chapter — this whole book — is not just pages. It's *evidence*. Of a man unarmed but undefeated. Of a soul crushed but not erased. Of a father whose love was louder than courtrooms.

This is what it looks like to scream without violence. To rage without destruction. To fight without fists.

This is what it looks like to make pain eternal — in the right way.

And if you're reading this, then the scream reached you.

Now scream back. With your own pen. With your own truth.

We don't need guns. We got stories.

Till I collapse.

CHAPTER 12: THE VILLAIN IN THEIR STORY

I wasn't always the victim, G. Sometimes, I was the fire. Sometimes, I was the storm that broke things. Sometimes, I said words that should never be said.

Let's not lie here. Let's not play perfect. This ain't about being the hero. This chapter right here is about owning my shadow.

Because the truth is... I hurt people. Not with fists. But with words sharpened by pain. With silence that screamed louder than any fight. With energy that carried rage I couldn't explain.

I called them names. Whore. Bitch. Slut. Not because I knew they were. But because I didn't know what else to do with the betrayal I felt. Because when love starts slipping through your fingers, you reach out with whatever's left. Even if it's fire. Even if it burns you both.

I wasn't right. I was just wounded. Wounded and loud. And the louder I got, the more I became the villain in their story.

They painted me black. Filed cases. Showed the screenshots. Told their side. And you know what? I can't even blame them.

They wanted to be safe. They wanted to be heard. They wanted the world to believe them. And maybe I gave them all the ammo they needed when I sent those angry messages. When I lost control. When I let my trauma speak louder than my love.

I didn't cheat. But I reacted like a man drowning. Accusing. Screaming. Breaking.

I let my fear of being betrayed turn me into something I hated.

But this chapter ain't just confession. This is transformation.

I ain't asking for pity. I ain't asking to be forgiven. I'm standing here, blood on my hands, saying: yes, I did that. Yes, I became the monster they said I was. Not always. But enough to leave scars.

But here's what they don't tell you: Villains got stories too. They weren't born dark. They were made. By pain. By fear. By abandonment.

And I was made in that fire. But I'm unmaking myself now.

Not to win them back. Not to erase what happened. But to stop repeating the cycle.

You see, G, if you can't look your shadow in the eye, it'll own you. But when you face it? You take your power back.

So this is me, no mask, no pride, just truth.

I was the villain in their story. But I ain't gonna be the villain in mine.

I write this not as a man perfect, but as a man aware.

And awareness? That's the first light after the darkness.

Let it burn. Let it cleanse. Let it be the start of something real.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 13: TILL I COLLAPSE

I almost didn't make it, G. Not just once. Not just twice. Too many nights where breathing felt borrowed, and waking up felt like a curse instead of a blessing.

There were no crowds. No cheers. No hand to pull me up. Just me, four walls, broken dreams, and one track on repeat: **"Till I Collapse."** Eminem. Nate Dogg. That beat. Every verse sounded like it knew me. Every bar hit like it was written for my bones.

This chapter is the breakdown. The burn out. The fuck-it moment where I didn't care if I lived or died — but I still wrote. Because somehow, the pen had more life than I did.

I bled in silence. I screamed inside my head. I cried without tears, because even my emotions were tired. But I didn't quit.

I couldn't.

I had kids. I had stories. I had demons to destroy and ghosts to speak to.

People think the hardest part is the pain. Nah. The hardest part is being in pain with no one to hand it to. The hardest part is carrying everything — past, present, shame, guilt, loss — and still acting normal.

They thought I was lazy. They thought I was lost. But G, I was dying slowly, and still showing up for people who wouldn't show up for me.

That's what they don't get. They don't see the war inside a man who refuses to surrender, even when everything inside him begs to stop.

And that night... The night when it got so loud, I couldn't hear my own heart? I played that track again. Volume on max. Pain on max. Bleeding on max.

"Till I collapse I'm spillin' these raps long as you feel 'em…"

I felt that. So I rapped with him. I let it all out. I punched the floor. I screamed until I collapsed.

But then? I got up. I wrote again.

Not because I healed. But because I refused to die without finishing this book. Without saying what needed to be said. Without letting the world know:

This pain didn't own me.

This chapter is for every man who broke in silence. Every man who felt invisible. Every soul who felt like they were screaming underwater.

You ain't alone. We still breathing. We still writing.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 14: THE DAY I SAID NO

It wasn't loud. It wasn't violent. But it was the most powerful moment of my life.

I said **NO**. To Erica. To the system. To being silent.

I said **NO** to the cycle that had me spinning in circles. To being the one who always had to explain, always had to fix, always had to swallow his pride while everybody else walked free.

I said **NO** to being the villain in every version of their story.

Because for too long, I tried to be what they needed:

- The calm one.
- The strong one.
- The one who says sorry first.

But they never saw the storm I was swallowing every damn day.

So I said **NO**. Not with hate. But with clarity.

I said no to the version of me that begged for love. I said no to the version of me that thought survival meant silence. I said no to the role they gave me.

Because truth is, G? I was never their puppet. I just forgot I had scissors.

The day I said no was the day I remembered who the fuck I am.

It wasn't revenge. It wasn't rage. It was **freedom**.

Freedom to not respond to every disrespect. Freedom to walk away instead of explaining myself. Freedom to no longer carry guilt that wasn't mine.

I let Erica go. I let the guilt go. I let the weight go.

That night, I sat alone. No applause. No validation. Just the silence. But for the first time, that silence wasn't empty — it was clean.

And I knew right there: this is the beginning.

Because sometimes, your power ain't in fighting back. It's in walking the fuck away.

No more chains. No more begging. No more dancing in their script.

I said **NO**. And that's when I started saying **YES** to myself.

To my peace. To my healing. To my voice. To my story.

This is the rise.

And it all started with one word:

NO.

CHAPTER 15: LOUIEWOOD

You ever hit the bottom so hard, the only thing left to do is create?

That's where I was. Not healed. Not clean. Not rich. Not even stable.

Just tired of being someone else's version of me.

So I built something — outta dust, pain, and pixels. Louiewood.

It wasn't a business plan. It wasn't even clear at first. Just a name. A spark. A corner of the internet where I could bleed truth and not get locked up for it.

People laughed. Ignored it. Told me to get a real job. But this was my real job: Surviving. Breathing truth into something that couldn't be taken from me.

Because they could take my freedom. My kids. My money. My name.

But not Louiewood.

That was mine.

No landlord. No system. No past could own that domain but me.

I wrote. I dropped tracks. I spit words into pages like they were the last bullets I had.

And all that struggle? I just put "HAHA" on all this pain.

It wasn't a joke — it was armor. Cause if I didn't laugh, I'd break. If I didn't build, I'd burn.

Louiewood became the place where I became me again.

And not just me — legacy.

A blueprint for the next broken soul. A map for the ones lost in the same storms.

It ain't perfect. It ain't viral. It ain't Forbes.

But it's truth. And truth outlives everything.

So if they ask what I been doing all this time?

Tell 'em: He was building Louiewood. Bleeding. Laughing. Writing.

And refusing to die without leaving something real behind.

Till I Collapse.

CHAPTER 16: IF YOU'RE READING THIS

If you're reading this… I made it. Not in the way they measure "making it." Not with money stacked to the ceiling. Not with fame flashing through screens. But I made it because I didn't die when everything in me wanted to.

I made it because I wrote this book instead of breaking my hands on walls. Because I screamed through a pen instead of punching people who never understood me. Because I turned the chaos into chapters. Because I turned the silence into a symphony of truth.

If you're reading this, I'm still here. Still standing. Still bleeding. Still building. Still a father. Still a warrior. Still a writer with nothing to prove but everything to say.

To my kids — Annica, Eira, Euno — this is your father's soul on paper. This is what I bled so you could breathe. So you could know that pain don't mean you're weak. It means you're real. It means you care too much in a world that rewards cold hearts.

If they ever tell you I was a failure, Let them. But read these words again. Because failure never wrote like this. Failure never fought through this much silence. Failure never stayed alive when the world tried to bury him alive.

Annica — you were my anchor. When the house turned to war, your laughter reminded me why I had to stay standing. When they tried to steal my reality, you held it down by just existing. Your eyes reminded me I wasn't born to kneel.

Eira — you were baptized in silence, but I whispered the truth in your ear: "You are not owned. You are free." I may not always be beside you, but I walk with you in spirit. You are power born in the middle of fire.

Euno — my youngest warrior, The world tried to separate us, But no court, no priest, no paper can erase what I carry in my chest for you. Your breath gave me a reason to breathe again.

To my parents, my bloodline — the ones who doubted, misunderstood, stayed quiet — I love you still. Not out of duty. Out of choice. Because even when you didn't believe in me, I believed in the blood that made us. And I turned your silence into gasoline.

To the men like me — the ones drowning quietly, grinding in shadows, Who scream into pillows, not people. Who write bars instead of starting fights. Who love hard and get called weak for it.

You are not weak. You are not broken. You are just unseen in a world that refuses to look.

But fuck it — let them not see. We'll write books they can't unsee. We'll build cities in silence. We'll plant legacy in the ashes.

To every person who tried to own me, Manipulate me. Twist my words. Rewrite my story. Erase my name.

I say this: I'm still here. And you can't kill a soul that writes its own truth.

They called me mad. They said I was angry. They said I was broken. But I was just breaking out.

This is for the ones in the room alone, screaming with no sound. For the fathers fighting cases. For the sons silenced by guilt. For the writers who bleed through their keyboards. For the warriors with no medals, no armies, just grit.

This book? It's not just mine. It's yours too. Every chapter written in pain Is a door kicked open for you to walk through.

And all that struggle? All that heartbreak? I just put "HAHA" on it now.

Because they tried to bury me, And I turned it into a garden.

Because they tried to silence me, And I turned it into a symphony.

Because they tried to end me, And I wrote this final chapter.

So if you're reading this, You're part of this now. You're family now.

And one day, when you hold your own truth in your hand, Don't apologize. Don't shrink. Don't wait.

Write it. Bleed it. Drop it.

Till I Collapse.

LETTER TO THE READER

If you made it here — to the end — then maybe you've felt it too.

The heaviness. The silence in the room when your world's on fire but nobody notices. The weight of being misunderstood. The guilt that follows you like a shadow even when you didn't start the war. The way systems wrap around your neck with smiles and rules.

I wrote this book bleeding. Not to blame. Not to play victim. But to show you that even broken hands can still write truth.

Maybe you're a father who's trying to stay strong while falling apart. Maybe you've been locked up for reacting to pain you couldn't explain. Maybe your family thinks you're lazy when you're just drowning in silence.

This isn't a self-help book. It's a survival note. A loud whisper in a world that tells men to stay quiet, act tough, and never cry.

But I cried. I collapsed. I almost gave up.

And then I wrote.

If you ever feel like you're the villain in their story — read this again. If you're tired of being strong and still getting blamed — read this again. If no one believes in you — I do.

Because the fact that you're still here, still breathing, still flipping these pages? Means there's something in you that refuses to die.

That's not weakness. That's proof of your fight.

We ain't meant to be perfect. We're meant to be real.

So if this book did anything for you — pass it on. Not for fame. But for the next man who might need to see his pain in someone else's words.

This ain't the end. This is the beginning of being unchained.

One page at a time.

— Louie

Acknowledgment

To the silence that became my therapy. To the pain that sharpened my pen. To every room I sat in, broke but breathing. To the nights I almost gave up. To the mornings I didn't.

To Leira — even in betrayal, you taught me what survival costs. To Erica — you showed me how quiet disrespect can burn deeper than words. To Annica, Eira, and Euno — you three are the reason I'm still standing. You are not my burden, you are my breath.

To my bloodline — my parents, my siblings, my nephews — even when you didn't see me, I saw you. Even when you doubted me, I kept fighting for us all.

To every friend who walked away, thank you. I learned how to stand. To every system that tried to own me, thank you. I learned how to break chains.

To every man out there carrying the weight in silence — this one's for you.

And to the music — especially Eminem. "Till I Collapse" became my heartbeat. You gave me the rhythm to write when I had nothing left.

This book was written in war. But it's dedicated to peace.

— Louie

About the Author

Louie is not just a name. It's a survival story.

Born into chaos. Raised in silence. Forged in betrayal.

Louie grew up in a world that misunderstood him — where truth was punished, and pain was buried. He's been locked in rooms, in systems, in cycles. But every time the world tried to erase him, he wrote louder.

A father. A fighter. A flawed but fearless soul.

He built this book not from comfort, but from the edge. From prison bars and court cases. From bleeding bank accounts and broken homes. From rooms that echo with music, rage, and prayer. He is not perfect — he is proof.

Proof that even the forgotten can leave legacy. Proof that even the voiceless can speak loud enough to shake generations. Proof that your story, no matter how shattered, still matters.

He built Louiewood not for fame, but for freedom — to plant his truth in soil that no one can own.

This ain't fiction. This is the raw blueprint of one man's war for soul, for family, for freedom.

And if you're still reading? You're part of it now.

About the Publisher

LOUIEWOOD does not bargain for space, nor does it seek validation from the gatekeepers of human potential. It stands as a borderless, sovereign monument carved from unbacked conviction, strategic alignment, and silent, merciless execution. From the most isolated corners of the map, we forge works that echo across continents—proving that a single, unyielding mind can shatter the global landscape without institutional millions or corporate permission.

We do not manufacture pages; we dictate legacies.

Every release under this banner is an act of absolute defiance. We build deep, immersive architectures of raw endurance—forged in the absolute quiet of the midnight hour where tears, scars, and internal warfare are converted into lethal literary weaponry. We do not offer comfort or fluff; we publish unyielding, cold-iron blueprints designed to amplify the voices of those who refuse to fold when the foundation cracks. Untethered by standard categories and free from conventional rules, LOUIEWOOD simply flows—establishing a permanent blueprint for a new era of sovereign expression.

The world draws limits. We erase them.

Witness the evolution at **louiewood.com**.

Unwritten Chapter (Louiewood Vault)

These are the pages that never made it to the main book. Maybe they were too raw. Too personal. Too loud. Too silent. But they're real. And real always matters.

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1. Prayers I Never Said Out Loud

God, I don't know if You hear me anymore, But if You do, Don't save me from this fire. Just let me walk through it without breaking.

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2. Things I Wanted to Tell Her

I never wanted to own you. I just wanted you to be safe beside me. But every time I bled, you smiled. And that told me more than words ever could.

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3. Louiewood Manifesto (First Draft)

Louiewood ain't a brand. It's a rebellion. A proof that you can rise from silence. That you can turn betrayal into blueprint.

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4. My Rules (Unspoken)

- Never beg to be understood.
- Don't explain your purpose to people who lost theirs.
- If they betray you twice, they were never for you.
- Keep building. Even if it's brick by broken brick.
- The ones who laugh at you now? Let them. That's fuel.

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5. Letter I Wrote While Locked Up (Unsent)

To my kids, If you ever read this, Know your papa was in prison, But he never bowed. They chained my body, but my pen stayed sharp. I didn't cry for help. I wrote for war.

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6. Dreams I Still Hold

- A house filled with peace, not fear.
- All my kids running around free, laughing.
- A table full of food I earned from my truth.
- A shelf with this book, worn out from being read.
- My name remembered not for pain, but for power.

These are the pages I wasn't ready to show. But if you made it here, Maybe you were meant to see the parts I tried to hide. Because real ain't always pretty. But it's always powerful.

"This pain didn't end me. It published me."